United States Filing Checklist

November 10, 2026

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United States Filing Checklist

Official starting point: [USPTO Provisional Application for Patent]

This checklist is procedural guidance, not legal advice.

A. Immediate provisional filing

DOCUMENTS

- [ ] `US_PROVISIONAL_SPECIFICATION_DRAFT.md`, reviewed for accuracy and converted to PDF.
- [ ] `PATENT_DRAWINGS.html`, exported as black-and-white PDF drawing sheets.
- [ ] USPTO provisional cover sheet PTO/SB/16 or an Application Data Sheet containing equivalent information.
- [ ] Basic provisional filing fee at the applicant's verified entity status.
- [ ] Optional claim appendix (`US_CLAIMS_DRAFT.md`) included to strengthen written-description support.

INFORMATION THAT MUST BE COMPLETED

- [ ] Exact title.
- [ ] Full legal name and residence of every actual inventor.
- [ ] Confirm each named inventor made a conception contribution to at least one claimed feature.
- [ ] Applicant/assignee identity and ownership basis.
- [ ] Correspondence address.
- [ ] Attorney/agent docket number if represented.
- [ ] Government-interest statement.
- [ ] Entity status (large, small, or micro) verified, not assumed.

TECHNICAL QUALITY CHECKS

- [ ] Every feature likely to be claimed in a later application is fully described now.
- [ ] Best mode known to each inventor is disclosed.
- [ ] At least one enabled implementation is disclosed for every claimed functional result.

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- ☐ Alternative implementations are described without relying solely on means-plus-function language.
- ☐ Drawings support every important structural and process relationship.
- ☐ No unsupported promise of closed-loop furnace control; the implementation is read-only advisory.
- ☐ The public EVRAZ dataset is identified as `public_reference`, not the applicant's plant and not live.

FILING

- ☐ File through USPTO Patent Center.
- ☐ Save the Electronic Acknowledgement Receipt and application number.
- ☐ Record the provisional filing date and exact 12-month nonprovisional/PCT deadline.
- ☐ Use "Patent Pending" only after obtaining a filing receipt.

B. US nonprovisional filing within 12 months

- ☐ Specification compliant with 35 U.S.C. 112(a).
- ☐ Claims compliant with 35 U.S.C. 112(b); target 20 total and no more than 3 independent unless fees are accepted.
- ☐ Abstract (150 words or fewer).
- ☐ Drawings compliant with 37 C.F.R. 1.84.
- ☐ Application Data Sheet claiming benefit of the provisional by application number and filing date.
- ☐ Inventor oath/declaration (PTO/AIA/01 or appropriate form).
- ☐ Assignment documents if ownership is transferred.
- ☐ Information Disclosure Statement listing known patents, papers, manuals, and public disclosures.
- ☐ Specification and claims reviewed against 35 U.S.C. 101, 102, 103, and 112.
- ☐ Consider PCT filing before the same 12-month priority deadline.

C. Public-disclosure and foreign-rights warning

- Public repository and website publication occurred on **10 November 2026**.
- USPTO states that an inventor-originated disclosure can fall within the AIA one-year grace period, but foreign rights can be lost.

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- The US deadline should not be treated as permission to delay. File promptly.
- Preserve exact copies, timestamps, commit hashes, and ownership of the public disclosure.
- Do not assume the disclosure came from all inventors. Counsel must map authorship and derivation.

D. Items not required in a provisional

- Formal claims are not required, although including draft claims can improve support.
- An oath/declaration is not required.
- An Information Disclosure Statement should not be filed in the provisional because it is not examined.

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